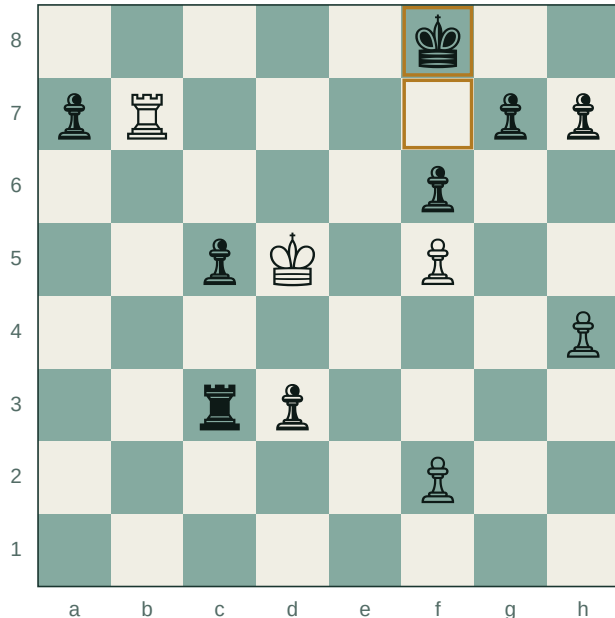


Rook-ending tactics: White, move 33

Rook-ending tactics

White to move



Previous move: 32...Kf8. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

33. Ke6 34. Kxf6 Ke8 35. Ke6

33.Ke6 The king moves from d5 to e6. Recorded reply: **33...g6**.

34.Kxf6 The king captures the pawn on f6. Recorded reply: **34...Ke8**.

35.Ke6 The king moves from f6 to e6.

At the end, nominal material is White 8 / Black 10 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +1: the balance goes from -3 to -2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A routine rook placement can miss a skewer or promotion with check. Let concrete tactics override a guideline when they conflict.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Rook endings combine pawn races with checks, cutoffs, and promotion tactics. Activity is vital, but the exact move order often decides whether a pawn can advance safely.

HOW TO LOOK

Check the kings' exposure, the rooks' checking distance, and the passed pawns. Calculate forcing checks before applying a general rook-ending rule.

The defending king is on f8. Geometrically undefended: rook on c3. Check for tactical protection.